

Matthew Dingee

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Portfolio: <https://www.abarrelofthis.com/>

Human-centered designer and front-end developer with nearly 30 years of experience. I specialize in the hardest design problems — the ones that take years, not sprints, to move. For the last decade in public service I've led design practices, design systems, and the governance that holds quality in place on a platform serving millions of Veterans, while building the tools that help designers work well with AI.

EXPERIENCE

Department of Veterans Affairs

GS-2210-15

Design Community of Practice Lead

June 2026 - Current

Lead the VA-wide Design Community of Practice, guiding the design discipline through a major organizational restructuring while sustaining design quality, governance, and delivery across Veteran-facing products.

- Conduct performance evaluations and monthly one-on-one mentoring for design leads spanning research, accessibility, and design system functions.
- Lead the AI prototyping enablement program — training, AI Skills, prompt libraries, and standards for agentic tooling — supporting 10+ VA designers actively producing accessible, testable Veteran-facing prototypes.

Platform Services & Governance Crew Lead

June 2024 - March 2026 (1 year, 9 months)

Crew Lead for Platform Services and Governance, managing a team of 4 designers across UX/CX measurement, accessibility, and design governance functions — and Product Owner of the VA Collaboration Cycle, the design governance process for a platform supporting 60 product teams.

- Scaled the Collaboration Cycle from 22 touchpoints per quarter in 2023 to a peak of 84 — nearly tripling throughput as platform adoption expanded — while maintaining consistent quality review across design, accessibility, engineering, and security tracks.

Served as Functional Lead on a \$7.4M Technology Modernization Fund investment from GSA — co-authored with OCTO Design Director Kevin Hoffman and Budget Lead Joshua Cohen — to modernize the VA Design System and improve form creation, authenticated experiences, and data visualization for Veterans and VA clinicians.

- Led the team that digitized and shipped 10 Veteran-facing VA forms, including the 21-4138 Statement in Support of Claim, saving an estimated 2,385 years of cumulative burden time for approximately 350,000 Veterans.

Led the VA-wide Zero Silent Failures initiative as Goal Champion — charged by the OCTO Chief Technology Officer following two Congressional testimonies — to eliminate a class of failures in

which VA.gov accepted a Veteran's form submission that then failed silently in handoff to downstream systems, with no notification to the Veteran.

Design & Forms Systems Product Owner
April 2022 - Current (4 years, 3 months)

- Designed, built, and published the VA Design System MCP server, an open-source Model Context Protocol integration with 8 tools covering component lookup, validation, token management, and Figma integration — enabling AI coding agents to generate VA-compliant interfaces directly from the Design System.
- Wrote a Product Requirements Document and then built the VA Prototype Kit, a toolchain allowing designers to build interactive prototypes from real Design System components with AI agent assistance — reducing the time to produce an accessibility-ready, testable prototype from weeks to days.
- Piloted and scaled both tools to 10+ VA designers actively using the toolchain, producing testable Veteran-facing prototypes including an Overpayment Balances flow ready for usability testing — confirming the approach reduces technical barriers for non-engineering designers.

U.S. Digital Service

Digital Service Expert
GS-343-14, Promoted to GS-343-15
June 2019 - June 2023 (4 years)

Team lead on USDS support of the Treasury Department Emergency Rental Assistance program to distribute government funds to state and local rent relief programs — leading a team of three and serving as liaison to Treasury leadership.

Contributed to the completion of the first pilots of the Subject Matter Expert Qualification Assessments (SME-QA) process with USDS teammates and the Office of Personnel Management.

The Lab at OPM

Management Program Analyst - Lead Designer, USAJOBS Project
GS-343-13, Promoted to GS-343-14
October 2015 - June 2019 (3 years, 8 months)

- Supervised expert designers for the full duration of the role — beginning with 2 and growing to 3–4 — holding monthly one-on-ones providing critique of their work, developing their abilities, and instituting regularly scheduled design critique.
- Developed and delivered design education offerings on Information Architecture and Problem Framing for The Lab's Design School sessions.

EightShapes, LLC

Senior Interaction Designer
November 2011 - July 2015 (3 years, 9 months)

Design systems consultancy delivering billable client engagements for Marriott, Cisco, and NCARB.

Earlier Experience

Microsoft — Senior Software Engineer (2008–2011). **Tellme Networks** — Software Engineer, promoted to Senior Software Engineer (1999–2008). **WebTV Networks / Microsoft** — Customer Service, promoted to Team Lead of the Previews beta program, then Service Operations Team Lead (1996–1999).

EDUCATION

George Washington University - Washington, DC
Bachelor of Arts, American Literature

Portfolio and code samples at abarrellofthis.com. References available by request.